Agentic Commerce: When AI Enters the Shopping Journey

From product discovery to decision intermediaries: what brands and retailers control.

Dirk Buursma

Commerce Partners

INTRODUCING COMMONWORK

Commonwork

The Collaborative Commerce Network

AI recommends the product—and points to the seller.

One response shapes consideration before a store visit.

Editorial summary of the supplied assistant response

Portugal · lightweight, compact toddler stroller · €400–€700 demonstration budget

> **“My best fit is the Joolz Aer²…”**

Joolz Aer²	**Bugaboo Butterfly 2**	**Nuna TRVL lx**
Joolz Portugal	Bugaboo Portugal storefront · El Corte Inglés Portugal	Gotu Portugal
[S1]	[S3] [S4]	[S5]
Is the product considered?	**Are its facts accurate?**	**Is our shop offered as the seller?**

Perplexity shopping-research example · Portugal request · One session; not a product test or visibility benchmark · No purchase demonstrated

Destinations are reported in one supplied response; verify current offers.

Agents, assistants and new decision intermediaries

They can shape discovery, comparison and the next action at different stages.

01

Research

Find and interpret information for a customer task.

02

Recommend

Compare options against the request and preferences.

03 · Separate published example

Delegated checkout

OpenAI · 29 September 2025 · source describes U.S. users and participating sellers.

User confirms order, shipping and payment details; seller handles acceptance and fulfillment.

Open OpenAI source

Research, recommendation and checkout are distinct capabilities. The Perplexity example above does not show a purchase.

OpenAI · 24 November 2025 OpenAI · 29 September 2025

Visibility for brands, retailers and platforms

These are questions to investigate—not results to assume.

01

Brand

Was the product understood and considered?

02

Retailer

Was the offer accurate and this seller included?

03

Platform

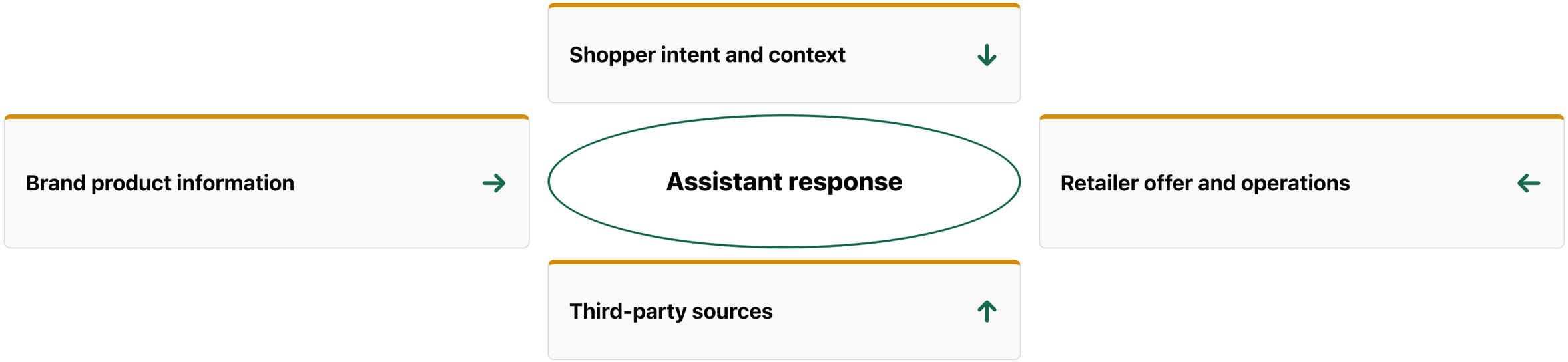
Where did discovery, comparison and the next action happen?

Analytical questions—not answers asserted for a particular retailer.

OpenAI · 24 November 2025 OpenAI · 29 September 2025

Who controls which parts of the journey?

Inputs, platform rules, permissions and seller actions have different owners.



Illustrative influence map—not a documented technical architecture or a complete factor list.

Influence is not control. No participant can guarantee placement.

OpenAI · 24 November 2025 Amazon · 13 May 2026

Expertise first. AI makes it more effective.

Marketing and operations experts can use AI inside controlled workflows.

Marketing

Task Respond to a customer question or campaign task.

Expert judgement Judge audience, suitability, differentiation, substantiated claims and channel.

AI contribution Assist with research, summarisation or adapting approved material.

Control Expert approves facts and brand/legal constraints; uncertain claims go to review.

Proposed measure Choose review time, correction rate and a campaign measure before testing.

Operations

Task Resolve a product/offer issue affecting a customer task.

Expert judgement Identify the source of truth, customer impact and safe correction.

AI contribution Compare records, summarise a mismatch or draft a work item.

Control Human approves data/system changes and handles exceptions.

Proposed measure Choose resolution time, recurrence, completeness and a customer/operations measure.

Dirk's recommended operating model. Illustrative workflows, not case studies.

Start with a use case. Build the foundation to scale it.

Govern product information and connect the systems the task needs.

01

Start with existing systems

Find current product/offer sources, owners and usable exports or feeds.

02

Assess gaps

Check attributes, variants, update timing, provenance, permissions and access.

03

Invest where justified

Improve PIM capability, APIs, orchestration or controls when a repeated need is clear.

Product-data ownership, sufficient PIM capability and appropriate feeds/APIs support reliable work. A new PIM is not required for every first experiment; APIs do not guarantee assistant visibility.

Google Search Central · Last updated 10 December 2025 Google Merchant Center Help · Current documentation; page date not displayed

Tools by job

Different tools do different jobs; vendor claims are not outcomes.

Geoffy

Product information
Vendor-described Product-page content and structured data; the vendor lists Optimise for Shopify and WordPress.
Monitor is early access; no independent outcome or Commonwork demo.

Geoffy Shopify App Store / Geoffy listing

Geoffy demo video withheld from the shared presentation pending content review and reuse permission.

Begen · AdMultify

Creative production
Vendor-described Generates ad-creative variants from supplied assets.
Not assistant-visibility measurement; no independent campaign outcome or Commonwork demo.

Begen

Rierino

Commerce operations
Vendor-described Commerce services, APIs and agent orchestration for operational workflows.
Vendor-described platform; confirm module and scope. No independent result or Commonwork integration.

Rierino Rierino documentation

Vendor descriptions are not independent outcomes or Commonwork demonstrations.

Start with one bounded use case

Choose a task, establish a baseline, test with controls, then decide.

01

Choose and baseline

One customer task, an expert owner and a success measure.

02

Assess

Product data, system access, permissions and controls; start with existing systems.

03

Test and review

Run a human-approved AI workflow; review results and exceptions, then repeat, stop or invest.

Start with one customer task—not a platform replacement.

Optional exercise: visibility worksheet